

Lumo

Make hard product decisions faster, and learn from every one.

Terrance Range | Solo build: product, design, engineering | www.trylumo.co

01 The short version

Lumo is for product managers who have to make a hard call and then explain it to everyone it touches.

You write down your first instinct. Lumo reads the situation back, lays out options, helps you commit with a written trade-off, and drafts the message for each audience. Then it remembers the decision, so it can show you where your instincts hold up and where they don't.

I built it end to end as a work sample. It is a prototype, but a real one: live model calls, a custom domain, English and Spanish.

02 The problem

AI gave you more options. It didn't give you more judgment.

Product managers make a hard call, then spend days explaining it to every team. AI sped up the drafting. It did not make the decisions better, and it never remembered how last quarter's calls turned out.

	Good at	Falls short
Chat assistant	Fast thinking on one decision	Forgets it. No record of your first instinct.
Decision journal	Keeps the history	All manual, so it dies in a busy week
Docs and Slack	Easy to share	Reasoning gets buried, outcomes never connect

03 Who it is for

A working PM who makes calls with real trade-offs: what to sequence, which date to promise a customer, what to cut. Short on time, answerable to leadership, and stuck writing the same decision five different ways.

Principles I set before building

Capture the instinct first

Ask for the raw take before any analysis, so it can be checked against what happened.

Never fake it

Real model output, real user input. Sample content is labeled as a sample.

Zero friction to start

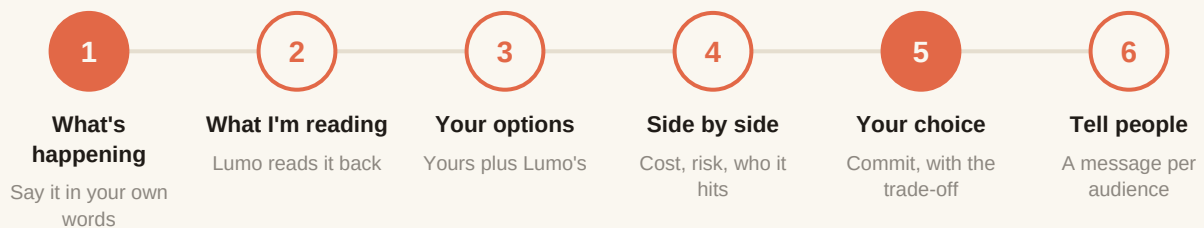
No account, no install, no approval from IT.

Interrupt the next mistake

Show a pattern when you are about to repeat it, not in a report.

04 The six-step flow

The whole product is one path. The AI helps in the middle. The first and fifth steps stay yours.



Over time, Lumo can say: you have been this sure about a date ten times. Seven slipped.

05 Decisions I made on purpose

Your instinct goes in first

Step 1 captures it before Lumo says anything. Without it there is nothing to learn from later.

You commit, not the AI

Choices, trade-offs and confidence are yours. Committing takes a deliberate hold, with an instant alternative for accessibility.

One decision, many voices

The VP, the team, other teams and customers each get a draft in the right channel, plus likely pushback and a reply.

Restraint over polish

Calm tone, little motion, one serif signature line used four times. No exclamation points.

06 How it works, briefly

Nothing exotic. The effort went into making the AI predictable.

Layer	Choice	Why
App	Next.js 16, React 19, TypeScript	Fast, searchable, strict types for AI payloads
AI	Claude with forced tool calls	Structured output, never free text
Guardrails	Server-side validation and retry	Bad output is rejected, not shown
Storage	Browser only, no sign-up	Zero friction. Decisions stay on your device.
Safety	Redis rate limiting	Controls cost on a public tool
Reach	English and Spanish, on Vercel	AI replies in the visitor's language

The model answers through a schema, and the server checks every draft before it reaches the screen. When something fails, the header says so honestly instead of showing a fake result.

07 What broke in production

The flow reset itself mid-step

An unstable React key remounted the step on every update. Fixed it, then re-tested all six steps in a real browser.

AI worked in preview, not live

The production runtime needed explicit model config. Centralized it and added visible AI status and logging.

Sitemap 404 on the live domain

Vercel sent the apex to www, my middleware sent it back. Made www the one canonical host.

The lesson

Test the deployed product, not the preview. Make failures visible. Treat domains and redirects as product work.

08 What I would build next

	Next step	Why
1	Outcome check-ins	Ask at a set date how it landed. That is the real data.
2	Patterns from real history	Replace the sample record with the user's own.
3	Accounts and sync	Keep the record across devices.
4	Slack and email, then teams	Send drafts where people work. Share the log.

*Lumo is my attempt at the part AI skipped:
better judgment, and a memory of how it turned out.*

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